

MARCH

MARCH 2

In the Shenandoah Valley, Sheridan defeats Jubal Early's Confederate force at Waynesboro.

MARCH 4

Lincoln begins his second term as U.S. president.

MARCH 7

At the Second Battle of Kinston, Confederate forces under General Braxton Bragg fail to halt the progress of Union troops advancing from Wilmington to join Sherman.

MARCH 13

In a last-ditch attempt to counter manpower shortages, the Confederate Congress authorizes the conscription of Black troops.

MARCH 16

Confederate forces led by William J. Hardee vainly try to delay the left wing of the Union advance in North Carolina at Averasboro.

MARCH 19-21

General Joseph E. Johnston's Confederate army makes a final, unsuccessful attempt to halt Sherman's advance through North Carolina at the Battle of Bentonville.

MARCH 22

A Union cavalry force under General James H. Wilson launches a raid southward through Alabama, intended to destroy Confederate resistance in the state.



Lincoln's gold mounted, engraved Henry rifle

MARCH 23

Sherman's Union army, driving northward through North Carolina, succeeds in rendezvousing at Goldsboro with Schofield's force, marching inland from Wilmington.

MARCH 25

A Confederate assault on Fort Stedman in the Union lines outside Petersburg initially succeeds, but is soon beaten back at a heavy cost in men.